Syllabus Edition
First teaching 2025
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Recruiting & Selecting Employees

Exam code: 0450, 0986 & 0264, 0774

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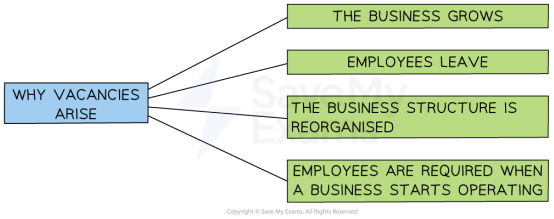
The recruitment process

- **Recruitment** is the process of **attracting and identifying potential job candidates** who are suitable for a vacant role
  - Recruitment activities include **job advertising, job fairs, social media outreach and referrals** from current employees

Reasons why vacancies arise



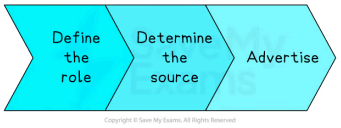
Vacancies can arise for reasons including business growth, employees leaving and reorganisation

- **During periods of business growth**, more employees are needed as the business expands its operations
- When an employee **leaves their job** and needs replacing
- Businesses often reorganise their **organisational structure**, which may result in the need for additional staff
- A **new business start-up** needs to recruit workers for the first time
- Businesses can choose to use a **recruitment agency** to carry out the recruitment and selection process on their behalf
  - New employees may be found **quickly** from its pool of available talent
  - Management **time** can be saved

Stuck on something?
Ask questions and get help with exactly what you're revising.
Got it

sites such as **LinkedIn** and **Indeed** helping businesses to share vacancy details and compare applicants

Stages in the recruitment process



The recruitment process starts by defining the role for which a vacancy exists

Step 1: Define the role

- Businesses should determine exactly what is required and part of that is developing a job description and a person/job specification
  - **A job specification** (sometimes known as a **person specification**) outlines the qualifications, skills, experience, and personal qualities required **from a candidate** for a specific job e.g. problem solver, good communicator, able to code in Java etc.
  - **A job description** outlines the duties, responsibilities, and requirements of a particular job

Comparing a person specification with a job description

Job specification	Job description
• Details the essential and desirable characteristics of the **person** suitable for the job including ○ Qualifications ○ Experience ○ Skills such as the ability to drive or IT capabilities ○ Personal characteristics and attributes	• Details the features of the **job** including ○ Duties ○ Hours and location of the job ○ Managerial or supervisory responsibilities ○ Pay and conditions

Help me understand

Step 2: Determine the source of employees

- **Internal recruitment** involves a business promoting or redeploying workers that already work for them

Advantages and disadvantages of internal recruitment

Advantages	Disadvantages
• Internal recruitment saves time and money because	• It can create jealousy or tension among

• It improves staff morale as employees see opportunities for promotion and career growth	• It limits the number of applicants, which may reduce the chance of finding new ideas or skills
• The employee already understands how the business works, which means they can start the new role more quickly	• Promoting someone internally can leave a gap in their old position that still needs to be filled

- **External recruitment** involves bringing in new workers from outside of the business
  - External recruitment can bring fresh ideas, experiences and perspectives to the organisation

Advantages and disadvantages of external recruitment

Advantages	Disadvantages
• External recruitment brings in new ideas, skills and experience that may help improve the business	• It is often more expensive because of costs related to advertising, recruitment agencies, and training
• The business has a wider choice of applicants, which increases the chances of finding the best person for the job	• It takes more time to recruit and train someone who is new to the business
• It can help increase diversity by bringing in people from different backgrounds	• New employees may take time to adjust or may not fit well with the existing team or business culture

Step 3: Advertise the role

- Roles may be **advertised internally** or **externally**
  - If the business is seeking an **internal candidate**, business newsletters, staff noticeboards or internal email can be used to display job advertisements
    - **Line managers** may be asked to **recommend suitable candidates** following **appraisals**
  - **External candidates** can be targeted with advertisements in newspapers, industry magazines, specialist recruitment websites, agencies and government-run agencies such as Job Centres
    - **Existing employees** may be asked to **nominate people they know** for roles , sometimes

- Businesses with a strong social media presence can use these platforms to advertise cost effectively e.g. Facebook, LinkedIn, TikTok
- **Specialist recruitment portals** may be used to advertise, such as The Times Educational Supplement, one of the main publications and websites in the UK used to recruit teaching staff

Examiner Tips and Tricks

Avoid mixing up a **job description** and a **person specification** – one explains the role, the other describes the qualities and skills of the applicant

Selection methods

- The selection process involves receiving applications, shortlisting candidates and choosing the most appropriate person(s) for the role

Receiving applications

- The business may **accept applications from candidates** via **Curriculum Vitae** (CV) and **covering letter** or **application form**
- Once applications have been received, the business **shortlists** suitable candidates
  - Candidates who best meet the essential and desirable criteria for the job opening in question are invited to the next stage of the recruitment process

Comparing application methods

Application form	Curriculum vitae (CV)	Coverin
• A **standardised** form **designed by the recruiter** to collect the same details from each candidate • Responses are collected in a **consistent format**and comparison is straightforward • A large volume of candidates can be **narrowed**	• A **professional document compiled by the applicant** • Details **career experience**, key **skills**and **strengths** • Includes **qualifications**and character/professional **referees** • Provides **contact details** for the recruiter to get in touch with the applicant	• A lett **acco the cand appli** form • Give **reas subn** appli • Draw atter the **appli parti suita** the r

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Selection methods

- A variety of methods can be used to **select the right worker** for the role

Interviews

- Interviews are commonly used to meet with candidates
- They usually include a face to face, telephone or online **discussion between a manager and the candidate** about their **suitability** for the role
  - It is important to prepare a **set of relevant questions** to ask all candidates and to ensure that the interview is conducted in a fair and consistent manner
  - Interview questions may focus on
    - **Skills and experiences** that are relevant to the job
    - **Successes and failures** - and how these were overcome
    - Personal **interests and experiences**

Selection tests

- Candidates may be asked to **undergo a test** to demonstrate their skills and suitability for the job
- **Candidates may be asked to complete** tests individually or within groups to assess how they may work as part of a team
- The different types of tests may include:
  - **Skills** tests (e.g. numeracy) show the ability of candidates to carry out certain tasks
  - **Aptitude** tests show the candidate's potential to improve or increase their skills
  - **Intelligence** tests are used to assess the candidate's ability to work at a desired level
  - **Personality** tests are used to identify desired characteristics or traits such as the ability to work effectively in a team

Assessment centres

- Candidates may be observed completing tasks such as
  - Group discussions
  - Problem-solving exercises
  - Presentations
  - Role-plays
- This method allows employers to assess a range of skills like **communication**, **teamwork**, **leadership** and **decision-making**
- Assessment centres are especially useful when selecting for senior or important roles

References

- This involve **contacting people who have worked with the candidate before**, such as previous employers or teachers
- References provide information about the candidate's past **performance**, **attitude**, **reliability** and **behaviour**
- They help to check that the candidate is honest about their experience and suitable for the role
- They are usually **collected after interviews** but before making a final job offer

Choosing who to employ

- The final decision of which applicant to employ depends on several factors
- Even when a suitable candidate is identified, the business will need to think about **whether it can finalise their appointment**
  - Can the business fulfil the applicant's **pay and conditions demands**?
  - Can appropriate **fringe benefits** be offered?
  - Are attractive **development opportunities** available to the applicant?

Factors used to select the best applicant

Factor	Explanation
Experience	• Which applicant has the most relevant work experience? • How might broader experiences help an applicant succeed in a specific role?
Qualifications	• Are formal qualifications **essential** for filling the post? ○ E.g. A teacher may require a degree in their specialist subject, whilst a retail store manager's experience is likely to be more relevant than formal qualifications

	operates? • Time may be saved on induction training and **productivity** may reach expected levels sooner than with an external candidate • How important is it that the new worker has **experience and skills gained from outside** the business? • New ideas, insights into competitor activities and different ways of working could contribute towards a business's competitive advantage
Gut feeling	• Will the worker 'fit' in with the business's culture and values?

Case Study

Recruiting For A Children's Bookshop

- A small children's bookshop business has received two applications for its advertised **sales assistant** role
- The shop owner is keen to select a **knowledgeable** candidate who is capable of delivering **good customer service**, **communicating effectively** with its (often young) customers and being willing to **support administrative tasks** such as banking cash
- Which of these two applicants would likely be appointed?

Applicant analysis

- Amira scored better in the assessment tests. She was nearly 20% better in communication

when working with kids

- Overall, Amira is a better fit for the role advertised

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